

Global CO₂ Emissions

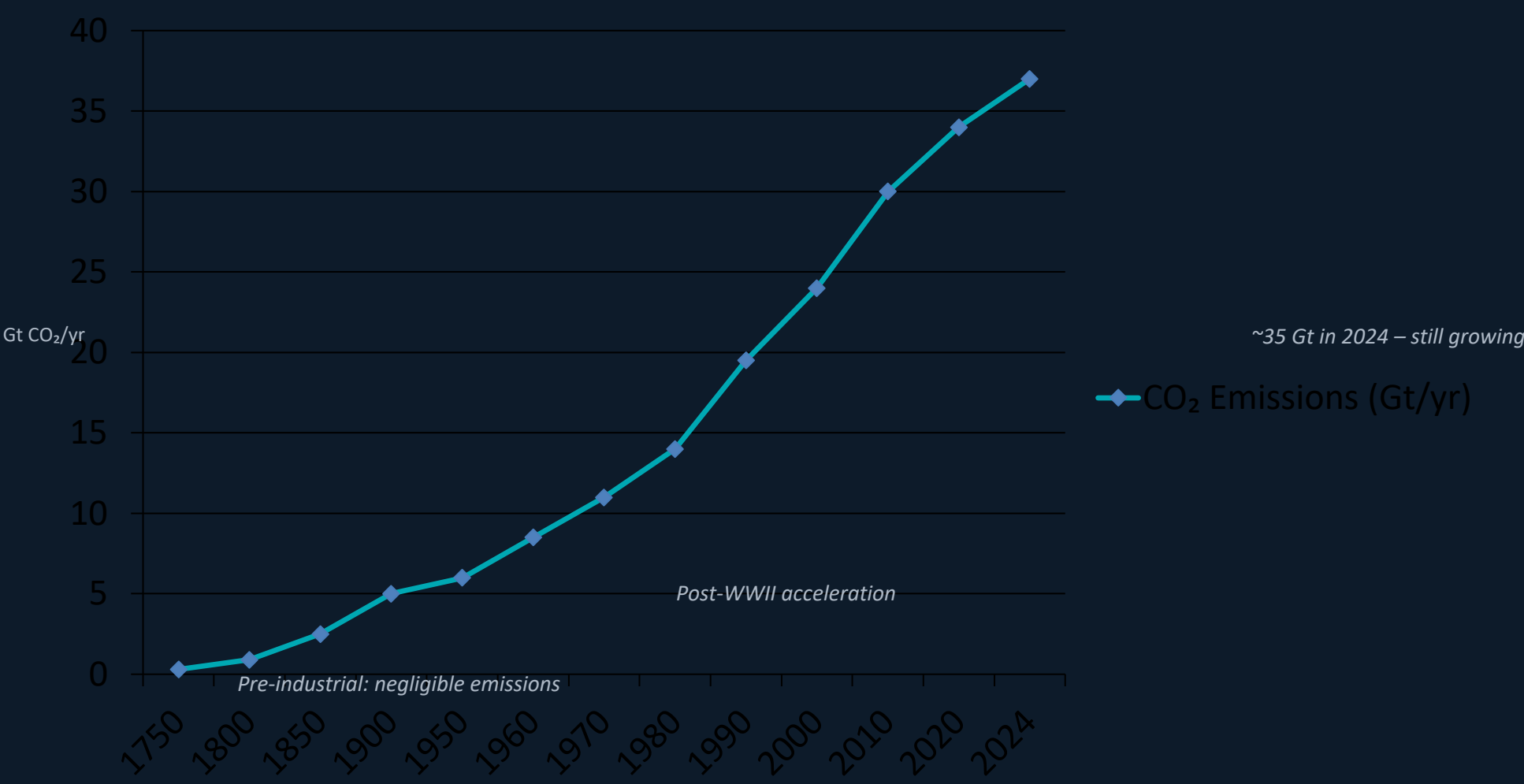
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Scope: Fossil fuels & industry | 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

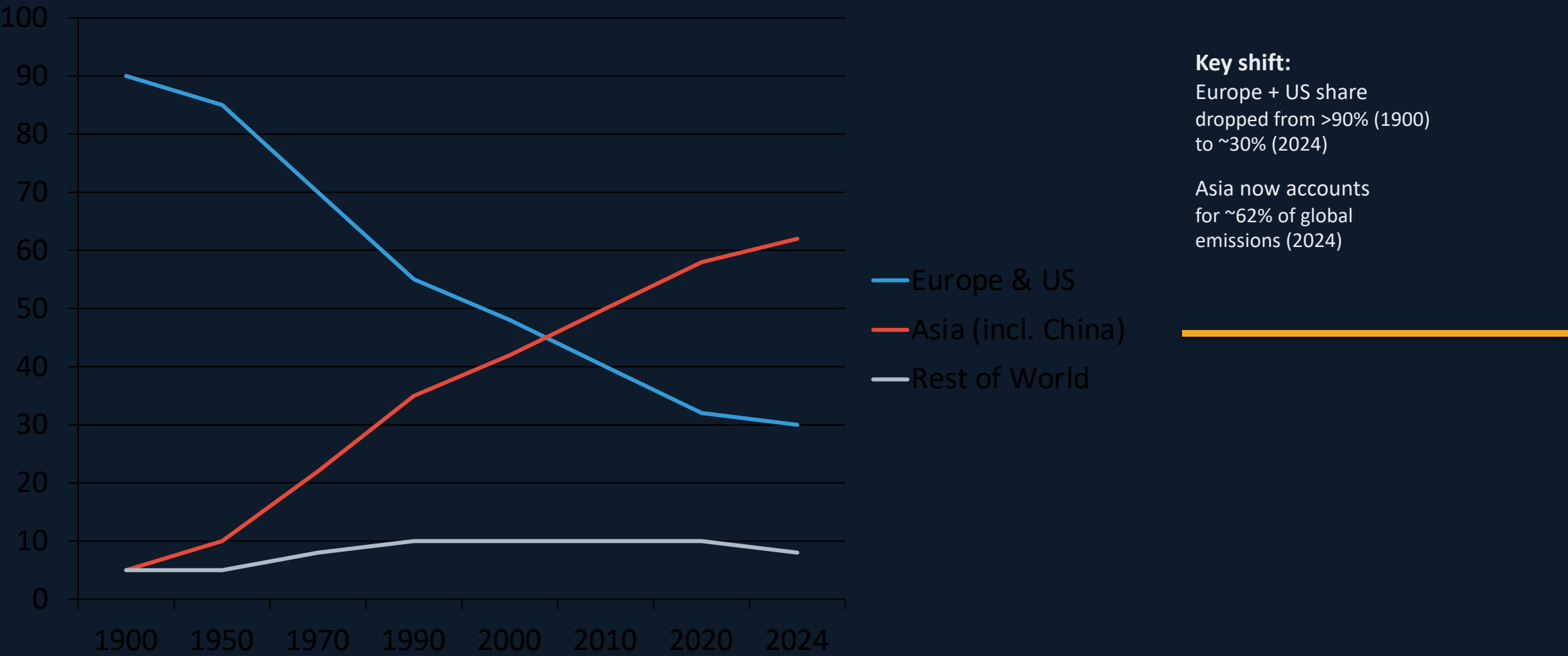
Audience: Policy analysts · Climate negotiators · Sustainability researchers

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



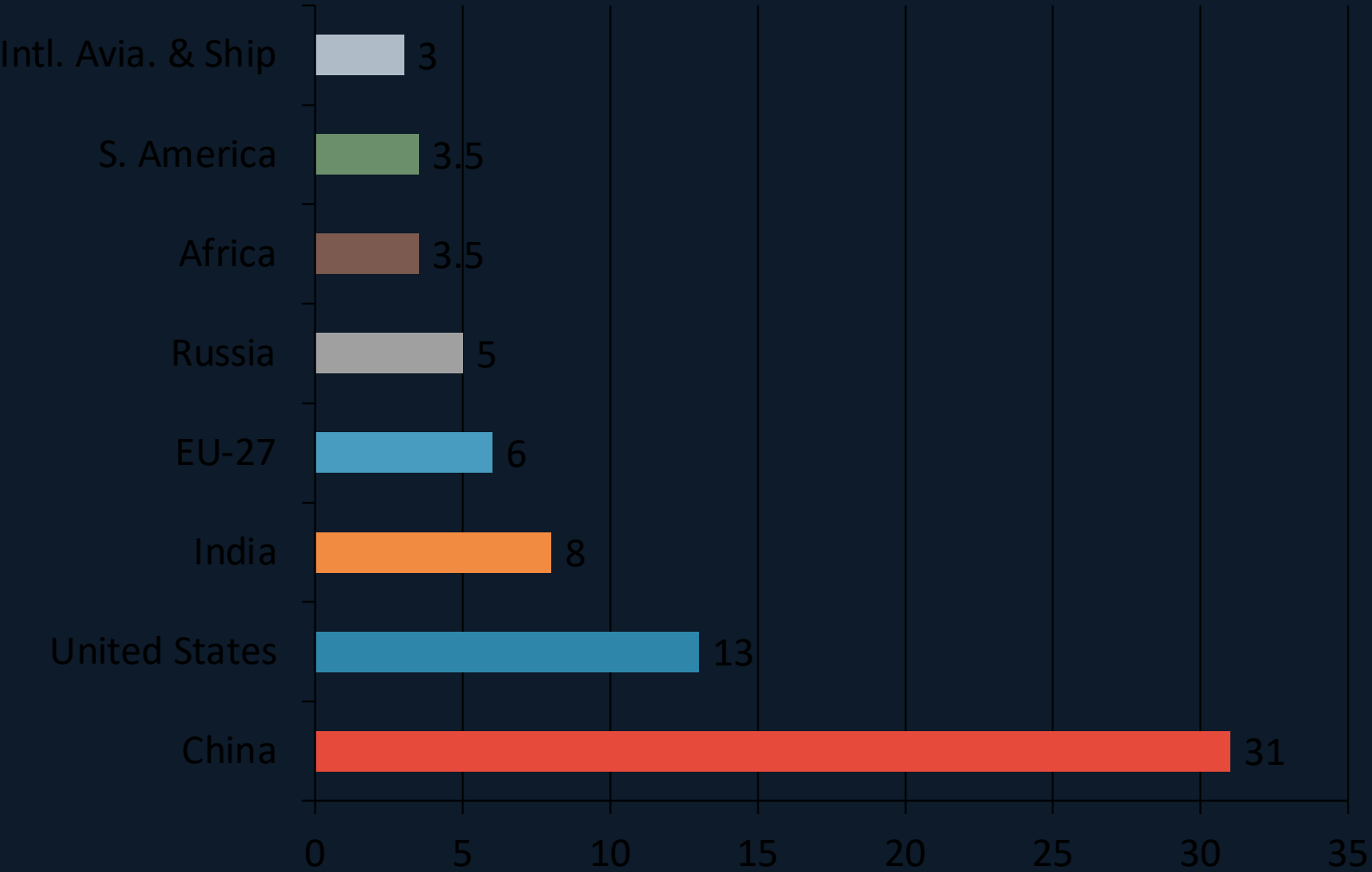
Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025, Our World in Data

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



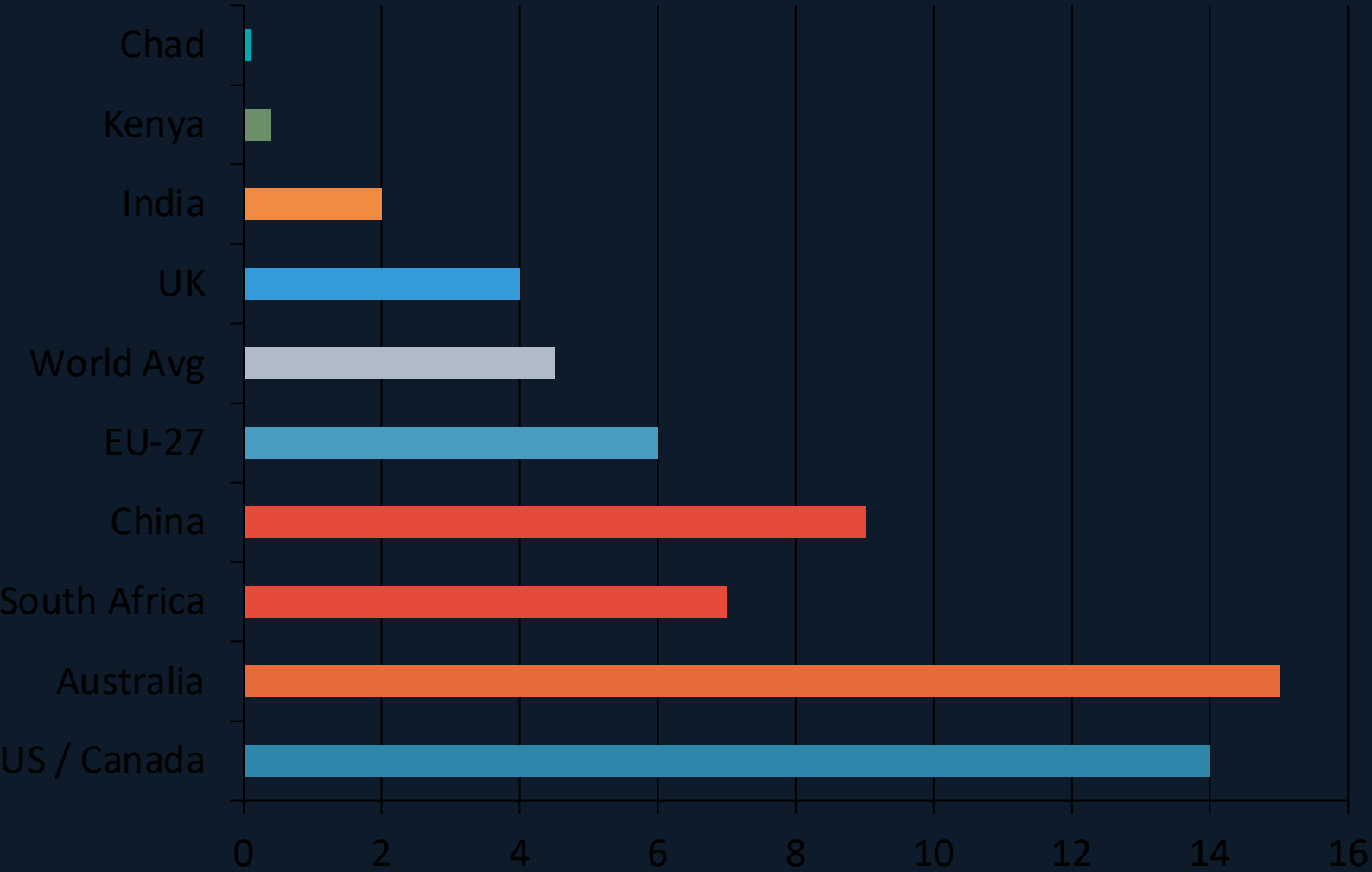
Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025, Our World in Data

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025, Our World in Data

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



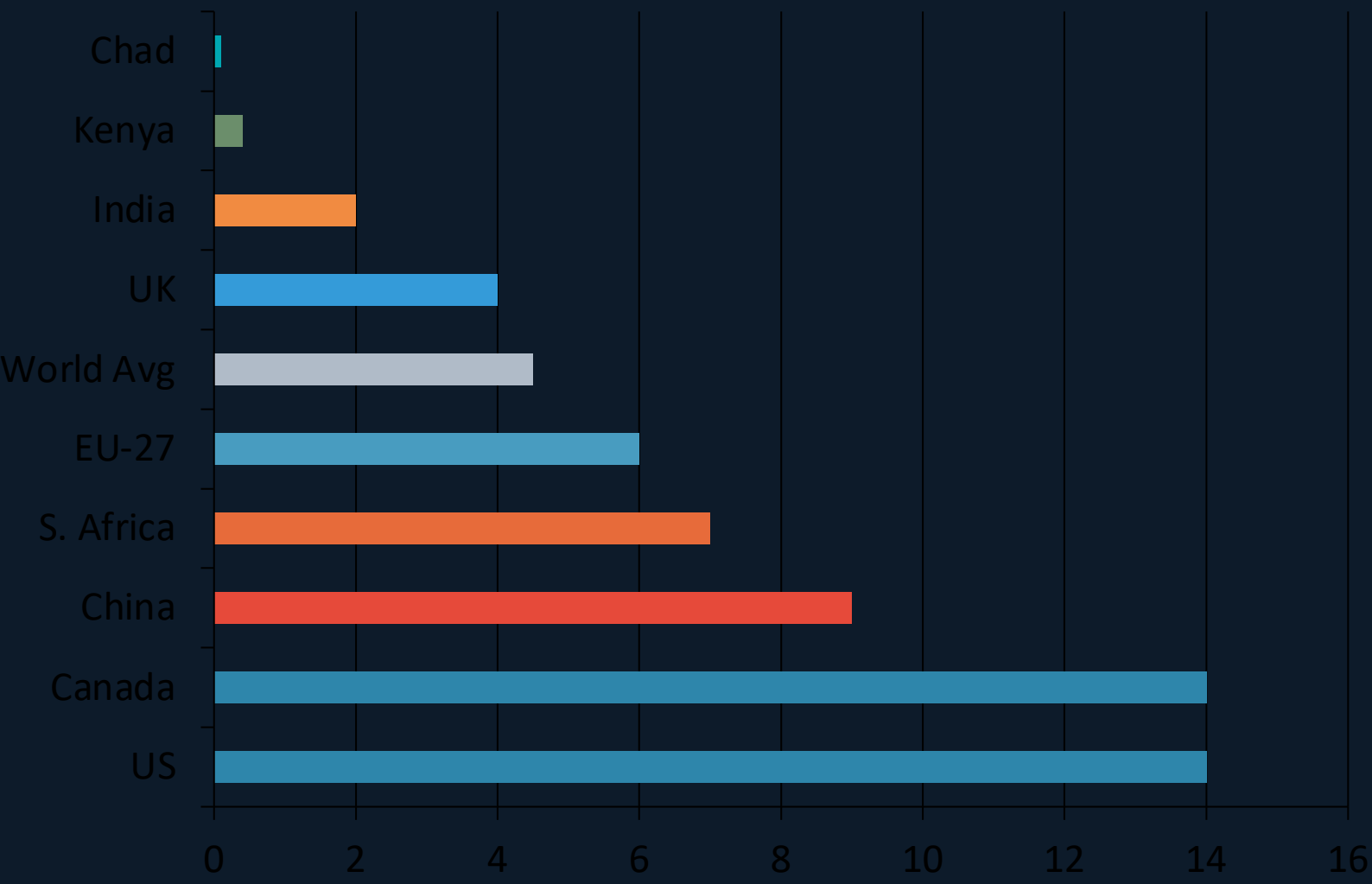
150× gap
The difference between lowest and highest emitters is roughly 150×.

An American emits in 2 days what a person in Mali or Niger emits in a full year.



Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025, Our World in Data

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

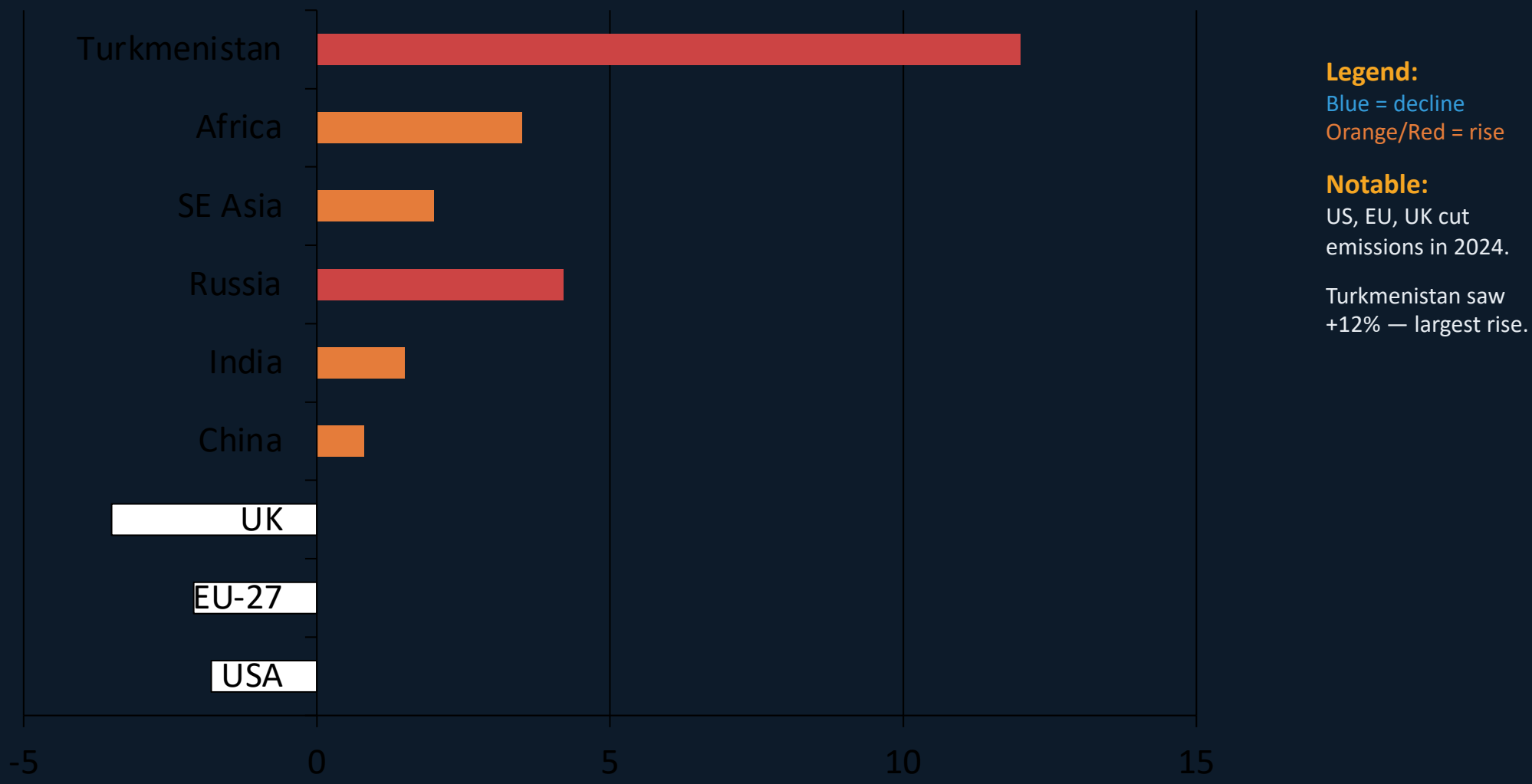


Key insight:
China is now the largest total emitter but its per capita (~9 t) remains well below the US (~14 t).

India remains very low at ~2 t/person.

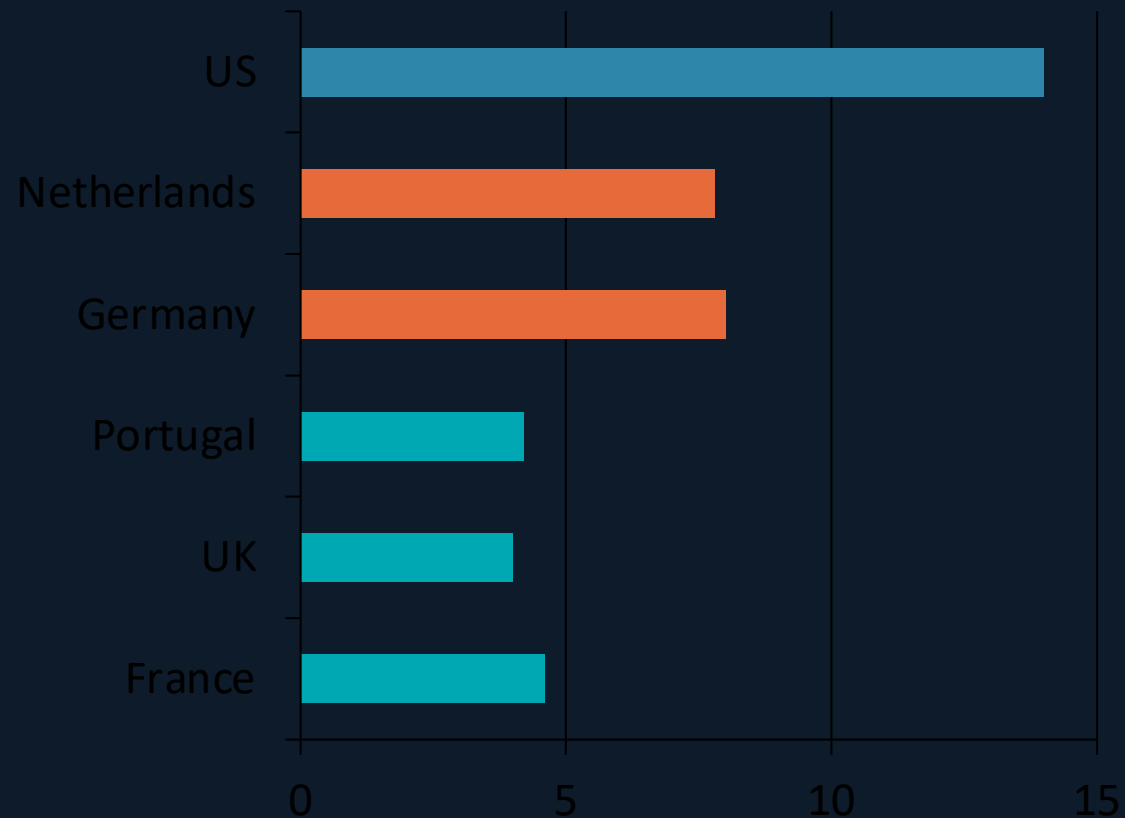
Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025, Our World in Data

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025, Our World in Data

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



Why does energy mix matter?

Among wealthy nations with similar prosperity levels, per capita CO₂ emissions vary dramatically based on electricity sources.

France, the UK, and Portugal emit far less per capita than Germany, the Netherlands, or the US — largely because a higher share of their electricity comes from nuclear and renewable sources rather than fossil fuels.

Key driver:

Nuclear: ~70% of France's electricity

Renewables: dominant in UK/Portugal

Fossil gas/coal: dominant in Germany/US

This shows that technology and policy choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

01

No peak yet

Global CO₂ from fossil fuels exceeds 35 Bt/yr and has not yet peaked, despite slowing growth.

04

150x per capita gap persists

The difference between the highest emitters (~14 t/person: US, Canada, Australia) and the

02

China is top emitter, but per capita is lower

China alone emits over one-quarter of the global total, yet its per capita (~9 t) remains well below the global average (~16 t).

05

Energy policy can decouple prosperity from emissions

US Counties with similar living standards have very different per capita footprints depending on

03

Historical responsibility dominated by Europe & US

Europe and the US once accounted for >90% of global emissions (1900); today they represent less than one-third.